

7th Grade

Social Studies

School Year 2026- 2027

Welcome!

Mr. Shank

Room 253 Humphreys MS

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Phone: 757-3365

Text:

American History (2016:Pearson)
and/or

Pearson Realize online textbook
(Savvas)

Class Times:

M,W,Th,F

A2/B2: 10:05-11:35

A3/B3: 11:40-1:35

Tuesday:

A2/B2: 9:45-10:55

A3/B3: 11:00-12:50

Grade 7 Social Studies is arranged chronologically and incorporates geography as well as economic, social, and political trends. The course content is divided into eight key ideas and five units, tracing the human experience in the United States from pre-Columbian times until the Civil War, with a focus on applying core skills to a study of significant people, events, and places. Throughout the course, teachers will help students see connections across time.

Learning & Teaching Philosophy

- I, as your teacher, will come to class prepared and with the intent to facilitate your best learning experience. I will try to make learning interesting and engaging. I will respect your attention spans, I will offer you a rigorous, challenging curriculum to help prepare you for the next steps in your education and life.
- We discuss ideas, issues, and values - both in literature and the world.
- We express our ideas, issues, and values through a variety of communication - either in writing, speech, or the arts.
- We explore ideas from multiple perspectives; we ask questions and respectfully consider the offered answers.
- We experience all that we can, so we can be more empathetic in a culturally diverse world.
- We connect what we are learning to other subject areas.
- We respect each other by working hard, knowing each other's limits, being tolerant and understanding, being responsible for ourselves and our actions, and maintaining a positive attitude.
- We come to this learning environment with the intent to learn, work hard, and be productive.

Major Instructional Activities: A variety of instructional activities will be used to explore the historical development of the United States during this period of growth and conflict. Map skills, textbook reading, reference books as well as other primary and secondary sources will be studied and utilized. Students will participate in group activities, informal presentations, research projects, simulation activities, and teacher-organized lecture/discussion activities.

Major Evaluative Techniques: Evaluation will consist of tests and quizzes, skills assessments, projects, document-based essay assignments, as well as oral and written reports. Evaluation will also include assessment of participation in individual and group activities.

Materials Needed: Each student will need the following materials in class every day:

- ☐ Pencils w/ Erasers
- ☐ Highlighters

Parent-Teacher-Student Communication

- Grades will be updated to Aspen Gradebook weekly.
- If your child's grades drop to a D, contact will be made.
- If there is a sudden drop in your child's academic performance, contact will be made.

Google Classroom

- Information on assignments, projects and tests will be posted in Google Classroom.
- Grades and missing assignments will also appear in Google Classroom. However, check Aspen for final grades.

Chromebooks

- Chromebooks should be at school **every day** and most importantly be **charged**. Students should keep their Chromebooks in the case when it's not being used to protect it.
- Students are only allowed to use their devices when directed by the teacher.

Homework, Assessments, and Deadlines

- Homework may be given to reinforce and extend classroom instruction.
- Deadlines will be communicated via Google Classroom and the classroom whiteboard.

Late Work Policy

- All assignments are considered for full credit if they are complete and ready at the beginning of the period.
- Students can submit late assignments before the end of the quarter. 15% will be deducted along with other points if criteria is not met.
- Parents may email me directly to discuss extenuating circumstances; reasonable accommodation can be arranged.

Absence & Make-up Policy / Google Classroom

When a student is absent, the time to make up work is equal to the amount of time absent from school. For Excused absences, students will have the number of days absent to make-up missing work for full credit.

Additionally, work is also posted in Google Classroom to help with planning and completing work at home or during your extended absence. Work is not posted weeks in advance (except in special circumstances, e.g. Early Acceleration). **** It is the student's responsibility to check with me for absent work and ask questions if they are having difficulty.***

Tutoring/Extra Help

- I am available before or after school by appointment only. Please feel free to contact me to set up your appointment.
- You can sign up for an Advisory session for assistance.

Classroom Expectations

The classroom is an environment for learning. Any problems that may arise will be handled accordingly. Parents are the first line of defense in this endeavor. All support is appreciated. Please contact me with questions or concerns. I will do the same.

- Come to class on time. Be in your seat when class begins.
- Be prepared to work and be productive.
- Problems are avoided when we...
 - Come to class with an "I will" attitude.
 - Bring required materials to class. Be ready and prepared to work.
 - Respect the learning environment - listen, be on task, follow directions, and clean up after yourself.
 - Practice honesty.
 - Are respectful with our words, actions, and nonverbal communication.
 - Participate in a helpful manner.
- If you cause a problem, I will ask you to solve it.
- If you can't solve the problem, or you choose not to, I will intervene.
- What I do will depend on the unique person and the unique situation. Everyone is treated as an individual.
- If you feel something is unfair, tell me quietly and privately, "I don't think that's fair." We will talk at an appropriate time.

If a student chooses not to exercise self-control, any of the following consequences may occur:

- Warning, 1:1 Conference
- Parent/Guardian contacted
- Detention after school or during lunch
- Removal from an activity
- Administration Referral

Bathroom Policy

- 10/10 Rule: Bathroom breaks are permitted during class, except during the first 10 minutes and the last 10 minutes of the period.
- Pass Required: You must take the official classroom bathroom pass with you whenever you leave the room.
- Sign In & Out: You must record your name, departure time, and return time on the sign-in/sign-out sheet located by the door.

Non-Negotiable Items

Some offenses are so severe that there will be no warnings given and the student will be immediately referred to the office and removed from the class. If you are being bullied or harassed, please contact Mr. Shank, another teacher, principal, or school counselors immediately. You have the right to a safe learning environment.

- Sexual harassment in any form - blatant or subtle innuendoes
- Racism in any form - blatant or subtle innuendos
- Bullying in any form - blatant or subtle innuendos
- Classroom violence - throwing items, or "in your face" aggressive behavior

Overall, we all have the right to feel safe and to learn. I also have the right to teach without having to deal with nonproductive behaviors. If we all do our job and respect each other's rights, it will be a successful school year.

-----return bottom portion only-----

My child and I have read and acknowledged the 7th Grade Social Studies syllabus:

Parent Name (please print): _____

Parent Signature: _____

Date: _____

Student Name (please print): _____

Student Signature: _____

Date: _____